



▲ **Gujarati thali:** A meal rich in pulses, which contain around 20-25 per cent more protein than eggs, fish or flesh. Also, it comprises green vegetables, yogurt and dairy products.

Surprise, traditional Indian meals are the best. Savvy tips from diet gurus on food that works.

slaves to that routine: lunch was a happy family affair usually followed by a siesta, and dinner was taken before sundown. Our modern lifestyles have thrown all that luxury for a toss.

Mealtimes have shrunk. The kitchen is no longer our biggest activity area. "Rapid transformation in the lifestyle of Indians, particularly those living in urban India, has resulted in a dramatic increase in the consumption of fast food and ready-to-eat meals. The main reason for this is conven-

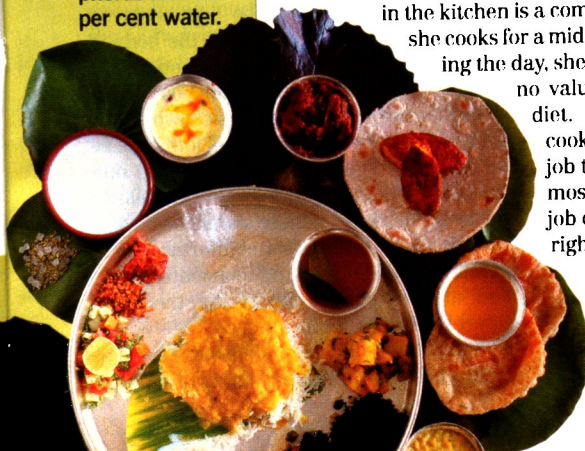
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▼ **Marathi platter:** Includes yogurt. When compared to milk, it contains more calcium and protein. It contains a good amount of phosphorus and 80 per cent water.

ience," says Veena Aggarwal, vice-president of VLCC. In urban India, where time is more important than money, it's tough to return from office and put the hours into cooking that a typical Indian meal demands. Also, with disposable income going up, young Indians do not mind shelling a few extra bucks to buy packaged food.

Indian lifestyle is undergoing a massive socio-economic change, which is also being reflected in the food habits of middle-class Indians. Take this: IT executive in Mumbai Sushmita Bhowmick says she cooks one meal a day. She puts in 60 hours at work in a week, and her only indulgence in the kitchen is a combination of vegetables that she cooks for a mid-morning snack. Later during the day, she lives on fast food that does no value addition to her healthy diet. Not that she doesn't like cooking, but with a demanding job to cope up with, she has almost shunned the painstaking job of chopping and mixing the right ingredients.

This year's edition of the National Sample Survey gives out some interesting results. Eating leafy green vegetables is becoming in-





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